

Quality of Student Learning Index (QSLI)

A five-index framework for measuring institutional quality

Designed as an institutional research framework to give university leadership a consistent, defensible way to compare quality across academic and student-facing functions. Each of the five indices below breaks institutional quality into weighted components, each with defined indicators, data sources, and collection tools mapped down to the course, program, school, and university level.

Quality of Student Learning

7 weighted components · 42 total indicators



Component	Weight	Indicators	What it measures
Proficiency Gains	20%	9 indicators	Growth in analytical writing, reasoning, quantitative literacy, and disciplinary skills across time.
Practical Application	20%	6 indicators	Ability to apply theory to real-world, social, ethical, or local contexts.
Pedagogical Alignment	15%	5 indicators	Coherence between learning outcomes, teaching methods, and assessments.
Classroom Ecology	15%	4 indicators	The quality of interaction, respect, engagement, and learning norms in the classroom.
Intellectual Stimulation	10%	8 indicators	Courses that challenge assumptions, provoke debate, and encourage independent thinking.
Inclusion	10%	5 indicators	Students feel respected, heard, and able to participate regardless of background.
Integrating Interdisciplinarity	10%	5 indicators	Connecting ideas across disciplines, especially through the Liberal Core.

Quality of Academic Programs

7 weighted components · 65 total indicators



Component	Weight	Indicators	What it measures
Teaching & Assessment Quality	25%	9 indicators	Effectiveness of teaching, assessment, and feedback in supporting and accurately evaluating student learning.
Student Academic Experience	20%	12 indicators	Overall quality of the student journey, including workload, difficulty, guidance, and progression through the program.
Curriculum Design and Program Structural Coherence	20%	11 indicators	Logical organization, sequencing, and integration of courses to ensure a cohesive learning pathway.
Institutional Resources & Support	10%	13 indicators	Availability and adequacy of resources, infrastructure, and support systems enabling teaching and learning.
Program Governance & Quality Assurance	10%	11 indicators	Effectiveness of policies, processes, and oversight in ensuring transparency, consistency, and continuous improvement.
Career Alignment	10%	4 indicators	Alignment of program content and skills with labor market needs and career pathways.
External Engagement	5%	5 indicators	Extent of collaboration with industry, academia, and other external stakeholders to enhance program relevance.

Quality of Faculty Performance

5 weighted components · 58 total indicators



Component	Weight	Indicators	What it measures
Teaching Effectiveness	30%	8 indicators	Assesses the extent to which faculty deliver rigorous, well-structured, outcomes-aligned teaching.
Student Experience with Faculty	25%	14 indicators	Quality of the student learning experience with faculty — engagement, inclusivity, mentorship, intellectual growth.
Research & Scholarship	15%	8 indicators	Faculty contributions to knowledge creation, with emphasis on rigor and interdisciplinary inquiry.
Service & Governance	15%	15 indicators	Contributions to institutional functioning and shared governance within the academic community.
Innovation & External Engagement	15%	13 indicators	Efforts to advance pedagogy, foster interdisciplinary learning, and connect academic work to external communities.

Quality of Student Support Services

6 weighted components · 59 total indicators



Component	Weight	Indicators	What it measures
Student Well-being & Mental Health Support	30%	6 indicators	Emotional, psychological, and holistic well-being support.
Academic Support Effectiveness	20%	7 indicators	Quality, accessibility, and effectiveness of academic guidance and learning support systems.
Financial & Accessibility Support	20%	26 indicators	Equity of access and inclusivity in support systems.
Administrative Efficiency & Service Responsiveness	10%	5 indicators	Efficiency, timeliness, and ease of interacting with administrative systems.
Career & Future Readiness Support	10%	6 indicators	Effectiveness of transition from university to careers / further study.
Student Engagement, Belonging & Campus Experience	10%	9 indicators	Sense of community, inclusion, and engagement beyond academics.

Quality of Alumni Success

7 weighted components · 38 total indicators



Component	Weight	Indicators	What it measures
Career Trajectory & Fulfillment	20%	9 indicators	Long-term career progression and sense of purpose in work.
Economic Returns to Education	15%	6 indicators	Financial gains and economic mobility associated with the degree.
Civic Engagement & Social Contribution	15%	6 indicators	Active participation in civic life and community impact.
Professional Skills & Workplace Effectiveness	15%	4 indicators	Effective application of skills in professional contexts.
Transition Efficacy	15%	6 indicators	Smoothness and success of the shift from university to work or further study.
Intellectual & Personal Growth	10%	4 indicators	Continued development of critical thinking, adaptability, and self-awareness.
Alumni Network Gains	10%	3 indicators	Professional and social benefits gained through alumni connections.

Prepared by Amna Shahid. Full component-level indicator detail, data sources, and collection mechanisms available on request.